County Council Meeting
Beaufort County, SC

Hilton Head Island Branch Library
11 Beach City Road
Hilton Head Island, SC 29926

Monday, July 13, 2026
6:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/393287

1. Call to Order

Chair Howard called the meeting to order at 6:28 PM

Present
Chair Alice Howard
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member Logan Cunningham
Council Member Gerald Dawson - Virtual
Council Member York Glover
Council Member Mark Lawson
Council Member Lawrence McElynn - Virtual
Council Member Joseph Passiment
Council Member Thomas Reitz

Absent
Vice-Chair Anna Maria Tabernik

2. Pledge of Allegiance

Chair Howard led the Pledge of Allegiance and gave the invocation.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Chair Howard stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve the agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve the minutes from the Special Called County Council Meeting January 20, 2026, Special Called County Council Meeting May 19, 2026, and Caucus and County Council Meeting June 22, 2026.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 9:0.

*Council Member McElynn dropped off

6. Administrators Report

Michael Moore, County Administrator, recognized Daniel Drudi, a Solid Waste and Recycling employee who saved a resident's life at the Bluffton convenience center. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/393287

7. Presentations Items

a. Recognition and Check Presentation to Operation Patriots FOB

Jon Rembold, Director of Airports, presented a check to JR and family from Operation Patriots FOB, from the Flying Frog 5k/10k. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full presentation. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/393287**

8. Public Comment Period

Public comments were made. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full comment period. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/393287**

9. Liaison and Committee Reports

Council members gave updates on committees. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/393287**

10. Approval of Consent Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve the consent agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

CONSENT AGENDA

a. Items Originating from the Public Facilities and Safety Committee

1. A Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) with Smyrna Concrete LLC and Beaufort County to donate concrete for improvements on Westbury Court in Bluffton. **(FISCAL IMPACT: There is no fiscal impact for the donated concrete. The contractor labor cost to construct and place the concrete is $24,237.00 to be requested at a later date.)** - Bryan Bauer, PE, Director of Engineering (5 minutes)

END OF CONSENT AGENDA

11. Agenda Items

a. Recommend approval to fund due diligence and negotiate terms of acquisitions for the following proposed Green Space Program applications: (1) John Farm I, II, III (2) Grid Properties Tract

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to separate the vote for the two properties.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 8:0

*Could not see Council Member Dawson and Council Member McElynn vote online

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve to fund due diligence and negotiate terms of acquisition for the following proposed Green Space Program application (1) John Farm I, II, III.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Council Member Brown. The motion passed 9:1.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve to fund due diligence and negotiate terms of acquisition for the following proposed Green Space Program application (2) Grid Properties Tract.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

b. 2026/28: An Ordinance amending Beaufort County Ordinance Chapter 102 Waterways. Article 1, sections 102–1 definitions, Article II, division 1, section 102-27, purpose, section 102-28, penalties, section 102-29, general prohibitions, section 102-30, dock rules, section 102-31, landing rules, division II, section 102-61, description, division 3, section 102-95, description, section 102-98, penalties, section 102-99 general prohibitions, section 102-100, dock rules, section 102-101, landing rules, Article III, section 102-133, definitions, section 102-134, penalties, section 102-136, student riders, section 102-137, public ridership.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on May 18, 2026 - 8:0
The vote at First Reading on May 26, 2026 - 10:0
The vote at Second Reading and Public Hearing on June 8, 2026 - 11:0
The vote at Third Reading and Public Hearing on June 22, 2026 - 11:0
N/A

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Lawson, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve Fourth Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/28.

Motion to Amend: It was moved by Council Member McElynn, seconded by Council Member Glover to amend the Ordinance requiring the Business License Bureau to issue a decal that can be a fixed to a vessel operating on the waterways so that the Code Enforcement Officer can visually establish whether or not that a vendor is in compliance with our regulations requiring a business license and required

insurance.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Passiment.

Voting Nay: Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Lawson and Council Member Reitz. The motion to amend failed 4:6

Main Motion: It was moved by Council Member Lawson, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve Fourth Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/28.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Council Member Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Council Member McElynn. The motion passed 9:1.

12. Ordinances for Second Reading

a. 2026/37: An Ordinance authorizing the abandonment of County Maintenance of a portion of Gibson Drive following petition by adjacent property owners and reclassifying said portion as a Private Road.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on June 15, 2026 - 8:0
The vote at First Reading on June 22, 2026 - 11:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve Second Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/37.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

b. 2026/38: An Ordinance to amend Ordinance 2017/12 to appropriate funds from the 2017 Series General Obligation Bond to the Station 34 joint Fire/EMS Station.

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on June 15, 2026 - 7:0
The vote at First Reading on June 22, 2026 - 11:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve Second Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/38.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

c. 2026/39: An Ordinance to amend the Fiscal Year 2027 Budget Ordinance to carry forward purchase orders and funds from Fiscal Year 2026 and prior for projects that have not yet been completed.

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on June 15, 2026 - 7:0
The vote at First Reading on June 22, 2026 - 11:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve Second Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/39.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

d. 2026/40: An Ordinance to reallocate remaining American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA) funds in the amount of $1,496,825.73 towards existing projects as obligated to the Department of Treasury.

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on June 15, 2026 - 7:0
The vote at First Reading on June 22, 2026 - 11:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve Second Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/40.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

13. Adjournment

COUNTY COUNCIL OF BEAUFORT COUNTY

Alice G. Howard

BY: _____
Alice G. Howard, Chairman

ATTEST:

Sarah W. Brock

_____
Sarah W. Brock, Clerk to Council
Ratified: August 10, 2026